

Regulatory, Legal and Public Response Plan

- When facing the ransomware incident, it must be handled as soon as possible or there will be huge punishments legally and damage to the shop's reputation which will cause them to lose current and potential future customers.
- The more damage the attacker is able to inflict, the more severe the punishment will be. For example, if the website faces long periods of downtime or confidential customer data stolen, the punishment will be more severe.



Credit to: <https://riskid.nl/en/compliance/>

Please see each plan below:



Credit to: <https://www.dreamstime.com/stock-books-representing-regulatory-compliance-legal-standards-forming-words-regulations-rules-guidelines-laws-image343559718>

Regulatory Response

- The shop's response will focus on industry specific regulatory requirements based around the retail industry.
- For example, the shop must adhere to GDPR and DPA due to the customers and employee's details that they will hold. (Centre, 2019)
- Report the incident to regulating bodies and agencies. This could lead to more severe fines if they don't comply and report as soon as they can. (Cullen, 2018)



Credit to: https://stock.adobe.com/uk/search?k=black+law&asset_id=2006529813

Legal Response

- The director and CSIRT need to collect and submit all of their evidence collected throughout the process of identifying and eradicating the attack.
- Explore hiring legal counsel to discuss options and to help the shop make sure they're compliant with all laws regarding the incident.



Credit to: <https://www.dreamstime.com/stock-illustration-public-relations-vector-megaphone-target-audience-logo-communications-icon-pr-image81973779>

Public Relations Response

- Customer services manager and director need to address the public and state the following:
 - Be honest with what happened to keep company reputation.
 - How the shop is addressing the ransomware incident.
 - Advise customers to take protective measures if necessary.
 - Update customers and team with updates along the process.



Credit to: <https://www.vectorstock.com/royalty-free-vector/writing-with-pen-on-paper-vector-4025712>

References

Centre, N. C. S., 2019. *National Cyber Security Centre*. [Online] Available at: <https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/incident-management/incident-response> [Accessed 31 May 2026].

Cullen, D.-T., 2018. *ProQuest*. [Online] Available at: <https://www.proquest.com/docview/2177380833?%20Theses&fromopenview=true&pq-origsite=gscholar&sourcetype=Dissertations%20> [Accessed 31 May 2026].

← [Previous: Ransomware Playbook](#)